

The film and television industries have been fighting an uphill battle against video game adaptations for 30 years now. There have been shows and films that have come fairly close to cracking the code; but by and large, looking at the ridiculous number of attempts that have been made to transpose the legacy of gaming into other mediums, there seems to be a fairly low success rate.

### In animation, we trust

We should make it clear right away that the animation industry has managed to squeeze out some degree of success in this department – especially several Japanese animation studios. Then again, anime has come pretty close to being video games themselves. There's a pretty good reason why gamers and anime fans find themselves in a similar social subset.

Honestly, someone somewhere should've taken the hint right there.

Meanwhile, one can extrapolate that unlike animation studios, a lot of live-action filmmakers struggle with the concept of a video game film. Simply put – they just don't get it. To assign credit where credit is due, people do understand how to cast the right people in the right roles. One can imagine Jason Statham as a mediaeval knight, Kristanna Loken as the leather-clad redhead vampire assassin, Freddie Prinze Jr as a military pilot or Milla Jovovich as the badass female protagonist of two very popular gaming franchises. Heck, even Michael Fassbender does a pretty decent job as an assassin across two eras.

Studios have pulled all the stops to picking the perfect actor, building the perfect world around them, and (late-ly) pushing VFX and CGI barriers to get the look and feel just right (*Halo*, *Warcraft*, yeah, we're talking to you). And yet, there seems to be something missing.

### And therein lies the rub

Despite all the effort that studios pump into casting characters and building worlds, few have stopped to look at the actual video games and see what really makes them work. Essentially, when your viewer pauses a movie midway to go back and replay their favourite video game, you've already lost the battle.

Over time, though, most studios have come to the same, somewhat belated realisation that if they want to bring in the views, they need to step back and really take a look at what works.

In recent years, Netflix has seen the most success because the streaming platform was quick to jump on the animation bandwagon. With *Skylander's Academy* and *Castlevania*, the OTT studio practically began the new wave of video game adaptations. In fact, some of the most gamer-approved adaptations are part of Netflix's arsenal – *The*

